

EXAMPLE OF A LOVE STORY

This story example is unique because the groom sent over his version as an almost complete story. I helped to put his and the bride's words together. Most stories develop over time, with notes and ideas coming from the couple and me.

Love can happen anywhere and at any time,
and if two people are ready to go on an exciting new journey, their lives will never be the same.
So how did Toni and Chris meet? Where did your love story begin?

Toni (*the bride*) begins our story:

“We met at work in a reception class while I was a general teaching assistant and Chris was a one-to-one teaching assistant. Chris explicitly stated, “I have no desire to be your friend” – very clear intentions – and without my knowing, he made the first of many moves to get my attention. Chris figured out my route home and would bump into me, claiming he had missed his bus so he could walk me home. Basically, he stalked me!”

This, Ladies and Gentlemen, is the story you know, and now, on his wedding day, Chris has the right to defend his honour.

So he will now explain, in his own words, that he did not stalk Toni.

Chris would never be so crude! In Chris's mind, he was a noble knight on a quest!

Chris describes how his quest for Toni's heart began:

“When I saw Toni for the first time, I was deeply resentful that I couldn't get her out of my head. I couldn't stop thinking how beautiful she was. I didn't like the power this had over me, but I couldn't help myself.

“I observed that she rarely smiled, so I tried using this to rationalise that she probably wasn't a friendly person. This helped for about thirty seconds, then I went straight back to obsessing about getting to know her. I tried to impress her by rolling on the classroom floor covered with Lego. The children laughed, but Toni was mildly unimpressed.

“Then I saw her smile for the first time, and I knew I was in trouble because I had never seen a smile like it. I knew it was a smile I would be chasing for the rest of my life. It was like kryptonite, but also crack cocaine... I just wanted more, even though it made me feel weak and powerless.”

“The child I worked with was absent for the next five weeks, so I was no longer needed at Toni’s school. They said if I was to get a different job, they would completely understand.

I decided to take a temporary job at another school so that I could return to Toni’s school when the child returned. My temporary job was two hours away, so I had to commute four hours a day for the next five weeks, just for the chance to see Toni again.

“I remember going to the staff Christmas party for Toni’s school and barely anyone recognised me, sitting on a stool that towered over everyone else’s chair with an adhesive name tag half-hanging off my chest – all in the hope of being able to snag a conversation with her.

“When I spoke to her, I noticed she couldn’t help but flatten the sticker on my chest.

I took that as game on.

“I managed to bump into her once after work and realised this was the road she walked down, so the next day, I visited three different pubs and scouted the seating areas in each one to find the best vantage point to look out the window so I could look down the road. Every day after work, I would go to the pub and order a half so I could safely down it if I saw Toni walking by. I didn’t want to slur my words when I made up an excuse as to why I was in the area.

“Day by day, Toni would let me walk her further along the road. Regardless of where we ended up walking, I would have enough adrenaline and endorphins to walk back home feeling like a mission had been accomplished because I discovered a tiny piece more about her; what she liked, what she didn’t like, and what she was up to over her weekends. Then one day, she finally let me buy her a non-alcoholic cocktail and sat down with me. I immediately opened up to her about anything, in the hope that my brash honesty and sense of humour would somehow impress her, or at least appear refreshingly different. It worked.

“And yes, it’s true. I would have rather died than been friend-zoned.

So when Toni insinuated we were friends, I said in no unclear terms,

“I have absolutely zero intention of being friends with you,”

I made it abundantly clear I was interested only in a romantic way, not a ‘let’s go shopping and talk about boys’ clothes’.

Toni tells us what happened next:

“Chris kissed me one January evening after I was annoying him.

I hid his phone behind me, and he leaned forward to take his phone, but he kissed me instead.

We moved in together with our cats in 2022 and have never looked back.”

Inspired by Toni's favourite Disney film, Tangled, Chris proposed in York, at the home of the Brontë sisters. Jane Eyre is one of Toni's favourite novels. That amazing moment in York brings you to this incredible moment now, and to capture what this day means, you have written some secret words, which you will share for the first time now.

Your first words are your secret answers to the questions I shared with you recently...

Question number one: choose three words to describe your beloved!

Chris, these are Toni's words for you: Loyal, Kind and Trustworthy

And Toni, these are Chris's three words for you: Patient, Beautiful, Wifey

Was there a moment when you knew you were in love?

Toni, you said this:

There wasn't a single moment of feeling like, 'wow, I'm in love with him.' It just... was. From the moment I heard him sing 'Lean on Me' to the SEN kid in our reception class, to our first kiss, I knew I was enamoured with him. Everything just fit into place, and that was it."

And Chris, you said this:

"I knew I was in love when I left Toni's school, and I couldn't stop thinking about her. So I chose to work a temporary job two hours away so I could return to her school.

What does Toni love about Chris?

I love how kind Chris is. I love how he'll go out of his way to help his loved ones, but also my loved ones. I see how he is with my family, how he absolutely adores my grandparents, how respectful he is to my parents, and how he fits in so well with my siblings, and I love him more for it.

What does Chris love about Toni?

Toni brought colour into my life when before, all I saw was black and white. She illustrated my world. I love the way she smiles and laughs at wholesome, silly things; the way she appreciates the little things;

the way she makes my stomach and heart feel calm,
and that I can be truly vulnerable to the world with her by my side.
She brought a Disney dream to life for me.

What makes you such a great team?

“We communicate and compromise,” said Toni, “Though I’m sure Chris will argue that I’m sometimes too stubborn to compromise! “When things go wrong, we don’t just talk at each other; we really listen to each other. Sometimes it may require a cooling-off period to do so, but we do.
We learn from each other, and grow together, rather than apart.”

Chris, you said this:

“We balance each other out to such a degree that many would see us as complete opposites. Where Toni sees logic, I see emotion. Where I see magic to be experienced in a moment, she sees memories to be cherished, years from now. It's hard to describe the yin and the yang of it. I think we protect each other from our weaknesses, and embolden us to embrace our strengths. We anchor each other with our different lenses through which we view the world.”

Do you have any favourite or funny memories of your time together so far?

“My favourite memory,” said Chris, “Is when I first tried teaching Toni to swim in the local swimming pool and seeing her doggy paddle towards me with hair across her face. It was a sight to behold! And then, years later, Toni giving up and just swimming on my back in Alicante...
(‘bout sums it up tbh!’)”

“Toni always says one of her funniest memories is when we were walking through the park. I was mid-sentence, and I inhaled a fly and coughed it up. I immediately continued talking after trying to brush it off. Apparently, the sound was hysterical!

Another one was when I was trying to troll Toni on the way back from the theatre.

We were on the escalator, and my shoe got stuck. The way fear pierced my eyes and I clung to her, fearing for the future of my lower limbs, always makes her laugh.

Recently we had a good one: Toni found it absolutely hysterical that I have such a large cranium that the overhang generated a tan line above my nose... she loved that.”

“Choosing a favourite memory is very hard to narrow down,” said Toni,

“So some of my favourites would be our first kiss; the proposal because it was just so beautiful; seeing Taylor Swift together; and seeing how Chris was with my family after the traditional wedding. The funniest memory would be doing ‘Go Ape’ as our first date, even though we both hate heights;

and when Chris swallowed a fly mid-conversation in the park; and when his shoe got stuck in the escalator after he was talking a load of nonsense.”

What have you learned in your time together?

Toni, you said this:

“I’ve learned to communicate and open up about my feelings.

I think very logically, and I don’t like to think about my emotions,

but Chris is the complete opposite, so he’s taught me to be more open

about my feelings and that it’s okay not to be okay.

I think I’ve shown Chris that not everything needs an emotional response or reaction, and that it’s okay to take a step back and think rationally.”

“I have learnt,” said Chris,

“How to become the man I always thought I would love to be.

Because that’s the man Toni deserves.”

What does Toni do every day to make life better?

Toni makes my mornings infinitely better than I can describe. She’s a walking, talking antidepressant first thing, as I’m a massive grouch. Every single day, Toni is an absolute godsend for morning grouches like me. Better than coffee and cocaine!

What does Chris do every day to make life better?

Chris says “I love you” all the time before leaving the house, and sends me an ‘I love you’ message if we haven’t messaged in a while. He calls me ‘gorgeous’ (my nickname) when answering the phone, and he carries my bags for me!

“Chris never fails to kiss my hand every time I reach out my hand to him. He could be in the middle of watching something or on the phone. He could be in the middle of doing anything, and he’ll never fail to kiss my hand.”

And finally, what are the secrets to a happy marriage?

Toni, this is what you said:

“To remember that we are now our own family,

communicating and having fun together.

Not everything needs to be so serious all the time.”

So very wise and true!

And Chris, these are your wonderful words:

“You’ve got to grow at all times.

This growth can be directed and aided by your partner,
but the hunger for it must be organic.

Communication is absolutely essential, and intimacy, of course.

Don’t take each other for granted; treat a marriage like a garden.

Beautifully maintained, it can look like a stunning ornament,
but if treated as such without maintenance, watering and care,
it can wither away and become something you want to draw the curtains on,
rather than something you want to race home to after a long day.”